

AZANIL 40MG/ML INJECTION

Description and Composition

AZANIL 40 MG/ML INJECTION is a clear yellow solution. Each ml contains 40mg Azaperone as its active ingredient and 0.5mg Methyl Paraben and 0.05mg Propyl Paraben as preservatives.

Pharmacodynamics

Azanil is a sedative butyrophenone neuroleptic with pronounced α -adrenergic properties for specific use in pigs.

Azanil produces a predictable psychomotor sedation without narcosis after intramuscular administration. The degree of sedation is dose-related. Adult animals require comparatively lower doses than half-grown animals. At low doses (0.5mg/kg), the animal is slightly sedated, yet it can be easily driven. With increasing doses, the animal becomes increasingly drowsy and slow. At 2mg/kg, it lies down for about 2 hours, can hardly be driven and ceases to be aggressive. The induction period is short. Peak effect is reached after about 15 minutes in young animals and 30 minutes in adult animals. The duration of action is 1 to 3 hours, depending on the dose and the weight of the animal.

Pharmacokinetics

Azaperone is rapidly absorbed from the injection site and peak concentrations in plasma occur within 1 hour after administration. The elimination from plasma is fast ($T_{1/2} = 2.5$ h), due to the rapid and extensive metabolism and excretion.

The main metabolic pathways are:

- 1) reduction of the butanone
- 2) oxidative N-dearylation
- 3) hydroxylation of the pyridine group

The target tissue for azaperone and its metabolites is the liver. Low residue levels are present in muscle and other edible tissues.

Indication

A neuroleptic sedative for pigs to be used for the treatment of:

- i) Aggression
 - Prevention of fighting
 - Treatment of aggression in sows
- ii) Stress, including transport-related stress.
- iii) Obstetric conditions e.g., cessation of parturition due to excitation, as an obstetric aid in manual delivery, inversion of the vagina, prolapse of the uterus, pathological straining.
- iv) Premedication in local and general anaesthesia.

Recommended Dose

It is important to adhere to the recommended dose. Aggression may only be curbed temporarily or not at all if the dose is too low. If the dose is too high, aggression may recur after awakening.

I. Aggression:

- i) Prevention and cure of fighting (including regrouping of piglets, porkers or fattening pigs): 1ml per 20kg body weight (2mg Azaperone per kg).

Pigs from different litters or pens may be brought together into one pen immediately after administration. All animals should be treated. After a few minutes, they lie down together for about 2 hours, irrespective of their origin. Afterwards, violent fights are unlikely to occur.

During the time of treatment, untreated animals should not be admitted to the run. The product will not prevent aggressiveness in non-castrated adult boars. Newly weaned piglets may be treated together with other routine treatments on arrival at the fattening unit.

Fighting animals become quiet shortly after injection. The animals are unlikely to fight even after the effect of the drug has worn off.

- ii) Treatment of aggression in sows, i.e. in sows that do not accept their new-born piglets, or bite them: 1ml per 20kg body weight (2mg Azaperone per kg).

The sow will accept her piglets $\frac{1}{2}$ to 1 hour after administration and will also accept piglets from other litters.

II. Stress:

i) Restlessness, anxiety, nervousness, excitation, e.g. because of pain: 0.5ml to 1ml per 20kg body weight (1mg to 2mg Azaperone per kg).

The dosage should be adapted to the degree of excitation. If the animal is very nervous, the product may be given in divided doses at 15 minute intervals.

ii) Transport of boars: 0.5ml per 20kg body weight (1mg Azaperone per kg)

The animals should not be brought together within the first half hour following injection because they are still likely to be aggressive; they should be left alone in a quiet environment during the induction period (approximately 30 minutes). The dose of 0.5ml per 20kg (1mg/kg) should not be exceeded as a higher dose may cause the penis to be extruded, which may then be damaged.

iii) Transport of weaners: 1ml per 100kg to 1ml per 20kg body weight (0.4mg to 2mg Azaperone per kg)

Administer 15 to 30 minutes before transport to reduce mortality and weight loss during transport. The dose can be increased up to 1ml per 20kg (2mg/kg) in order to prevent fighting during transport. Allow adequate space for animals to lie down and ensure that the lorry is adequately ventilated.

III. Obstetrics:

1ml per 20kg body weight (2mg Azaperone per kg)

For use in cessation of parturition due to excitation, as an obstetric aid during manual delivery, inversion of the vagina, prolapse of the uterus, pathological straining.

IV. Premedication in local and general anaesthesia:

0.5ml to 1ml per 20kg body weight (1mg to 2mg Azaperone per kg)

For example in blood sampling, diagnostic examination and minor therapeutic interventions under local anaesthesia (castration, cryptorchidism and prolapse of the rectum, inguinal hernia, wound treatment, insertion of nose rings in boars and sows, etc).

Exact dosage will depend on the type and duration of the procedure and concomitant medication.

Route of Administration

To be given strictly by intramuscular injection, behind the ear.

Contraindication

The use of the product should be avoided in very cold conditions because of a possible risk of cardiovascular collapse due to peripheral vasodilation.

A dose of 0.5ml/20kg should not be exceeded in boars as a higher dose may cause the penis to be extruded, which may then be damaged.

This product is contraindicated for use in transport or for re-grouping of pigs which will be slaughtered prior to the end of the 10 days withdrawal period

Warning and Precautions

Special warning for target species:

Occasional deaths have been observed in Vietnamese Pot Bellied pigs. It is thought this may be caused by injection into the fat leading to slow induction and tendency to use additional doses, leading to overdose. It is important with this breed not to exceed the stated dose. If the initial dose does not appear to have an effect, allow complete recovery before re-injecting on a different day.

Special precautions for use:

i. Special precautions for use in animals

After treatment the animal should be left alone in a quiet environment. Insufficient results may be obtained if the animal is disturbed or chased during the induction period.

ii. Special precautions to be taken by the person administering the veterinary medicinal product to animals

This is a potent drug - particular care should be taken to avoid accidental self administration. It is recommended that, once the required dose has been withdrawn from the vial, the needle should be kept guarded until the product is administered. Alternatively, the needle should be removed from the syringe and immediately inserted into the injection site, and the syringe should be connected to it.

Wash off splashes from skin and eyes immediately.

In the case of accidental self-injection, seek medical advice immediately, and show the package insert or label to the physician.

Wash hands after use.

Interaction with Other Medicinal Product

When given as premedication for general anaesthesia, the dosage of anaesthetic should be reduced because of the potentiating effect of azaperone.

Pregnancy and Lactation

Can be used in pregnant and lactating animals, and in particular obstetric conditions e.g. cessation of parturition due to excitation or as an obstetric aid to manual delivery.

Side Effects

Salivation and panting may occur at high doses. These side effects disappear spontaneously and leave no lasting damage.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose

If the dose exceeds that recommended, aggression may result on reawakening. In boars overdosing (> 1mg/kg) may cause the penis to be extruded, which may then be damaged. Salivation and panting may occur at high doses.

Repeat dosing in Vietnamese Pot Bellied pigs too soon because of absorption of the initial dose in fat has resulted in death.

Storage Condition

Store below 30°C. Protect from light.

Shelf life

3 years. Following withdrawal of the first dose, use the product within 24 hours. Any unused material should be discarded.

Withdrawal Period

Pigs: Meat: 10 days.

Packing

100ml.

Revision date: 13.2.19

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